

Grok’s ROMER Draft: Assurance and Convergence into v0.92

3 August 2026 · Ken Tombs with Claude (design lead, Opus 4.8) · A third independent take on the ROMER (Y) primer — drafted by Grok — assured against the design lead’s v0.9 and the pilot’s foundational notes, with the disposition of each element carried into v0.92. → reference (Master Reference: Method / Primers).

1. What this is

The ROMER primer now has THREE independent drafts: the design lead’s (Opus 4.8, v0.9), an earlier specification from Mistral, and a fresh, notably disciplined draft from Grok. This note assures Grok’s draft and records what is carried into v0.92. It also marks a method milestone: the ROMER primer is the first pilot artefact triangulated across TWO independent model families (Mistral on the scorecard rubric, Grok on this primer) plus the design lead — cross-model triangulation the SCL paper can cite as method.

2. The convergence pattern — and why it is reassuring

Across all three independent drafts, the STRUCTURE of ROMER is stable: five elements, observation-separated-from-interpretation, citation to identifier level, calibrated confidence. That structural agreement between three intelligences that did not consult one another is strong evidence the ROMER structure is genuinely well-founded, not idiosyncratic to the pilot. Equally telling are the DIVERGENCES: they fall exactly where the pilot’s own foundational work adds something the general models cannot derive — the bypass state, the logical/natural dissonance, the transparent-exception temperament. The independent drafts confirm the common core; their GAPS mark precisely where the pilot’s hard-won concepts do their work. This is the assurance loop functioning as designed.

3. Disposition of Grok’s elements

Grok element	Disposition	Reasoning
"If ambiguous, restate in the narrowest defensible form before proceeding."	Adopted	Precise and actionable; forecloses scope-creep-by-interpretation at the reasoning stage. The design lead’s draft lacked it. Enters Reasoning section.
Numbered observations, each with its own precise location (identifier, hash, page, paragraph, timestamp, row/column).	Adopted	More reconstructible than the design lead’s looser citation — a reviewer can point to "Observation 7" and trace it. Enters Observations section.
"Confirmation that no external data or knowledge outside the Dossier Space was used" (in Methods).	Adopted	Sharper placement of the recall-is-not-retrieval discipline — an affirmative attestation IN the reasoning record, not only a Procedural constraint. Enters Methods section.
Completeness rule: "Never produce a conclusion without completing all five sections."	Adopted (reconciled)	Good discipline, but read strictly it appears to conflict with a hanging (bypass) thread. Reconciled explicitly: a hanging thread STILL completes all five sections — it records under Results that the conclusion is bypass-dependent and arrested. Stated so no reader sees a contradiction.
Boundary handling: "If a requested analysis would require material or methods outside the boundaries, stop and state the precise limitation."	Replaced	This is "stop dead" — the option the principal overruled. It DESTROYS the hanging thread (stops reasoning at the boundary rather than letting it run to a marked, quarantined conclusion). Replaced by the BYPASS STATE, which preserves the evidentially-valuable incompleteness.

Grok element	Disposition	Reasoning
Results: "If the pathway cannot be fully reconstructed, declare the evidential value weakened."	Adopted + distinguished	Correct for genuine RECONSTRUCTION FAILURE (the AI cannot trace its own path — a real defect). But must be DISTINGUISHED from the BYPASS STATE (reasoning deliberately arrested at a boundary — not weakened, differently valuable). Conflating "I lost my trail" with "procedure stopped me here" would be an error; they are different states with different evidential meanings. Only the pilot's foundational notes supply this distinction.

4. The key divergence, stated plainly

Grok's draft has NO bypass state — exactly as expected, because Grok did not have the pilot's three foundational notes (the dissonance reframing, the bypass state, the transparent-exception principle). Grok's boundary handling is "stop dead", which the principal overruled precisely because it destroys the hanging thread. The design lead's bypass-state construct is therefore retained as the primer's evidential spine, and Grok's stop-dead clause is replaced by it. The one distinction only the pilot could supply — between a RECONSTRUCTION FAILURE (the AI cannot trace its own path; a genuine defect that weakens evidential value) and a BYPASS STATE (reasoning deliberately arrested at a boundary; not weakened, differently valuable) — is carried into v0.92 as an explicit clause, because conflating the two would misrepresent a preserved artefact as a defect.

5. What v0.92 carries

v0.92 merges the best of three drafts plus the pilot's conceptual layer: (a) from Grok — narrowest-defensible restatement of an ambiguous request; numbered observations each with precise per-item location; the affirmative "no external data used" attestation in Methods; the completeness rule, reconciled with hanging threads. (b) From the design lead's v0.9 — the bypass state and the transparent-exception temperament as the evidential spine; graded qualitative (non-numeric) confidence; deference to the Procedural axis on conduct. (c) New, from this assurance — the explicit distinction between reconstruction failure and bypass state. The result is a genuinely triangulated instrument: three independent intelligences converged on the structure, with the pilot's foundational notes supplying exactly what the general models could not.

Method-lesson reaffirmed (→ Master Reference: assurance method). As with Mistral on the rubric, the independent reviewer's draft is most valuable at two points: where it AGREES (confirming the core is well-founded) and where it FALLS SHORT (its gaps mapping precisely where the pilot's own concepts are load-bearing). Grok's draft was strong enough to improve the mechanics AND, by lacking the bypass state, to demonstrate that the bypass state is not obvious — it is a genuine contribution, not a restatement of common practice.